

though PHP remains its forte. It's got all the features you want in a good editor—syntax colours, a Code Inspector, debugger and so on. It also supports CVS and Subversion, so publishing your project on such version control systems isn't an issue either.

Remember that PHP is an interpreted language and doesn't require a compiler—if you're using PHP Designer for Java or C# files, the best you can get out of it is a respectable editor for your code—the absence of a compiler makes it a less desirable tool when it comes to these languages. It handles PHP quite well, though when we opened source code from the Joomla CMS, it couldn't auto-detect a couple of essential files that were in the same folder as the open document!

Another weird thing is that despite supporting HTML and XML, tags aren't automatically closed—if you start a tag called `<head>`, for example, it should automatically create a closing `</head>`. You'll find this functionality in a lot of editors, and we were disappointed with its absence. In the big picture, you don't want to use this for anything other than PHP, for otherwise it's just another text editor.

1.1.7 NetBeans IDE

Previously overshadowed by Eclipse (no pun intended), the NetBeans IDE for Java has finally matured into a product that seems to hold its own in the competition. It includes an in-built XML editor and supports the development of AJAX-based applications as well.



NetBeans is slowly gaining ground in the Java IDE market

Quite the space-saver, this.

Developing Windows GUI interfaces with NetBeans was a breeze—practically as simple as doing the same in Visual Studio.